



MARKETING LABS · CONTENT & COMMUNICATIONS

AIDA Marketing Communications Model

Plan the message people need at each decision moment.

Interactive AIDA marketing communications planning canvas for Awareness, Interest, Desire, Action and optional Retention.

Includes: framework reference · guidance by AIDA stage · printable worksheet

AIDA Marketing Communications Model: reference

INTERACTIVE MARCOMMS PLANNING PROTOTYPE

AIDA helps you structure campaign communications around four practical goals: become known, earn attention, make the proposition meaningful and help people take the next suitable step. Add Retention when ongoing customer value, trust, loyalty or advocacy matters after the initial conversion.

AIDA is a communication lens, not a literal customer journey. People compare alternatives, consult peers, revisit information and enter at different stages. Pair this canvas with customer research, channel data and accessible, truthful communications rather than assuming a single linear funnel.

AIDA communications map

Select a stage to see the planned message, touchpoint, next action and measurement approach.

Reach and recognition

Understanding and research

Relevance and preference

Friction-free next step

Long-term value

JOURNEY COVERAGE

All five stages are mapped. Validate the actual journey with research: people may enter, pause, compare and return at different points.

MESSAGE DISCIPLINE

Real-world AIDA tips

- Start with audience research: define the decision, context, barriers and trusted information sources before choosing channels or creative.
- Make every promise specific and supportable. Use evidence, representative examples and transparent limitations rather than generic superlatives.
- Match the CTA to the level of commitment: reading, saving, subscribing, booking, trialling and buying are different asks.
- Design for accessibility across copy, contrast, captions, keyboard navigation, forms, language and device conditions.
- Treat social proof responsibly: use real, consented testimonials and do not fabricate popularity, countdowns, availability or reviews.
- Use the funnel as a diagnostic aid, then check non-linear behaviour through customer interviews, journey data and support feedback.

Guidance by AIDA stage

Awareness / Attention

Awareness / Attention prompt: How will the right audience first notice and recognise the offer or issue in a credible, relevant setting?

All stages include measurement notes. At this stage, consider: Relevant reach, awareness, qualified traffic, recall, message recognition and brand search.

Interest

Interest prompt: What information will help people understand the problem, benefits, alternatives and relevance to their situation?

All stages include measurement notes. At this stage, consider: Engaged visits, content completion, useful questions, repeat visits, event registrations and qualified enquiries.

Desire

Desire prompt: What proof, experience or personal relevance helps people move from “this seems useful” to “this may be right for me”?

All stages include measurement notes. At this stage, consider: Demo requests, saved configurations, comparison engagement, case-study use, lead quality and stated preference.

Action

Action prompt: What is the appropriate next step, and how can it be easy, informed, accessible and proportional to the person's readiness?

All stages include measurement notes. At this stage, consider: Completed intended actions, conversion quality, abandonment reasons, accessibility success and consent quality.

Retention (optional AIDAR extension)

Retention prompt: How will the relationship continue to create real value after the initial action, while giving customers meaningful choice and control?

All stages include measurement notes. At this stage, consider: Repeat use, renewal, satisfaction, support outcomes, referrals, retention by cohort and customer lifetime value.

AIDA Marketing Communications Model: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Campaign, proposition or product

For example: Product launch, new service or public information campaign

AIDA stage

☐ Awareness / Attention ☐ Interest ☐ Desire ☐ Action ☐ Retention (optional AIDAR extension)

Audience need or task

What does the audience need to understand, feel confident about or accomplish?

Core message or proof point

State the message clearly and support it with credible evidence.

Channel or touchpoint

For example: Search, PR, email, website, webinar or sales conversation

Appropriate next action

For example: Learn more, download, enquire, book, trial or buy

Measure and ethical boundary

How will you assess usefulness while respecting consent, privacy and accessibility?

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.